9.10 Osteoarthritis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My knees hurt and are briefly stiff in the morning." **Objective** • Crepitus • Bony enlargement of the joints	**ACTUAL** Chronic pain related to joint degeneration as evidenced by knee pain and stiffness.	• Pain at a level that allows daily function.	• Give analgesia as prescribed. • Discuss weight management. • Teach use of heat or cold. • Encourage low-impact exercise.	• Goal reached when pain is manageable.
Subjective • "I cannot climb stairs because of my knees." **Objective** • Struggles with stairs	**ACTUAL** Impaired walking ability related to joint pain as evidenced by difficulty climbing stairs.	• Walks safely with an aid.	• Provide a cane, held on the good side. • Refer to physiotherapy. • Encourage weight loss if overweight.	• Met when walking safely.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Painful joints • Older adult	**RISK** Risk for adult falls as evidenced by risk factors: impaired mobility.	• No falls.	• Give fall-prevention advice. • Encourage strengthening exercises. • Check her footwear.	• Achieved if she does not fall.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [51], [100]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.